

Else you could lock the line of movement to a specific axis using the up, left or right arrow keys during the operation.

2.6.2 Rotating

Another SketchUp brainwave is the “Rotate” tool, which you can locate in either the toolbar above or the Tools menu. You could otherwise, simply use the keyboard shortcut “Q” instead. You’ll know it’s active when the cursor changes into a couple of circular arrows and drag along with it a protractor.

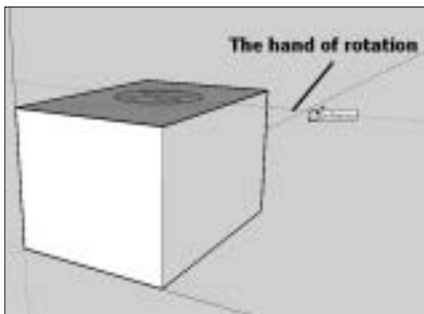
Here are the basics of using the rotate tool:

- Activate the Rotate tool as above. The cursor will now become a protractor with a circular arrow.

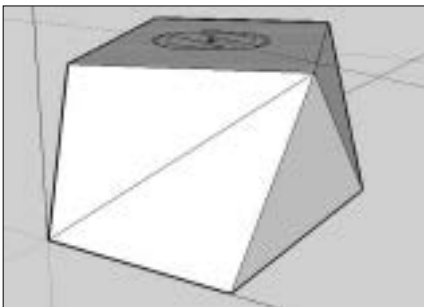
- As the mouse hovers over an entity, the protractor automatically orients itself to the surface.

The process now involves three clicks of the mouse: (1) A click to select an entity for rotation (2) a click to set a “rotation arm” with the help of which you can rotate the entity and (3) a click to finish the rotation operation.

- Click on an entity to select it for rotation. The point you click on will also be the centre of rotation and you can use the Inferences to choose the right point.



The dotted line functions as a lever you can use to rotate an entity



Mutations by rotation